

The UK's Most Valuable Companies

In partnership with Singer Capital Markets, we've identified the UK's most valuable high-growth companies, based on equity transactions over the last three years.

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Ranking and analysis of the top 200 growth companies by transaction-based valuations



Beauhurst



Top sectors for the most valuable growth companies
How many growth companies have undergone IPOs

Here's a sneak-peak inside

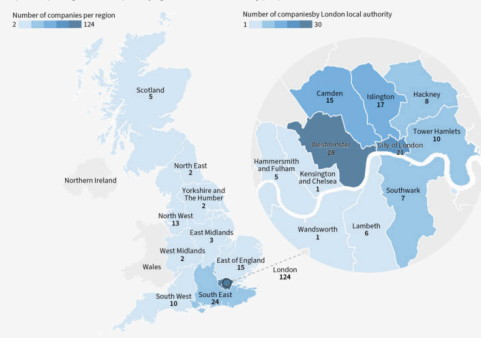
Regional distribution

The top 200 companies are largely based in London and the South East, reflecting the high number of financial services and technology companies that are able to command significant valuations with equity investors. Within London, the City of Westminster hosts 28 of the 124 companies, the highest of any London borough. It is followed by the City of London (21) and Islington (17).

Outside of London, the South East is the most populated region with 24 companies, with many companies active in the life sciences and technology sectors. Since the top 200 list was finalised in mid September, two of the life sciences companies in the South East, Oxford Nanopore Technologies (7) and Escentia (22) have listed on public markets via IPOs.

Looking beyond the south, the most populous regions are the North West, home to 13 companies and Scotland with five. Top-ranked in the North West is Aittrincham-based Matillion (50) whose software supports companies in loading data to the cloud. It has ranked among the 200 thanks to a \$100m fundraising in February 2021 that saw the company valued at £26m. It has since raised an additional \$150m in September. The top-ranked Scottish firm is Aberdeenshire beer maker and bar operator BrewDog (9), which was valued at £1.84b by a £22.6m round in November 2020.

Map of the top 200 highest value companies by region and London local authority (2021)



Growth factors

Beauregard uses tracking triggers to identify high-growth companies such as those featured in this report. The data on this page shows the frequency of achieving one of these triggers for the top 200 companies, providing some insight into the circumstances and events that have supported their growth journey.

The most common trigger achieved among the 200 companies was appearing on a high-growth company list. This was accomplished by 59% of the businesses and may represent a virtuous circle: companies that appear on such lists receive high public visibility, potentially helping drive further performance.

The second most influential trigger is having attended an accelerator, with 43% of the companies having done so. Such programmes provide high-growth businesses with access to expertise and sometimes funding in their earliest stages, likely contributing to their success over the longer term.



About the authors



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FREYA HYDE

Freya performs data analysis and visualisation in the Research and Consultancy team. She has worked on projects for Barclays, EY and JP Morgan. She holds a BA in History (International) from the University of Leeds, which included a year at Fudan University in Shanghai, and is currently learning Python for data science.



ALICE WILLIAMS

Alice executes statistical analysis and data visualisation for the Research and Consultancy team. Prior to joining Beauhurst, Alice read Law at Durham University, where she acquired an undergraduate degree (LLB) and a Masters of Jurisprudence.

If you work with high-growth UK companies, you need Beauhurst.

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